

Used to / Would (past habits)

CEFR B1

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

Use 'used to' and 'would' for finished past habits and states. Use:

- 1 Used to — past habits and past states — I used to smoke; there used to be a cinema here.
- 2 Would — repeated past actions, often in stories — Every summer we would go to the coast.

'Used to' works for both habits and states; 'would' only works for repeated actions, not states. The negative is 'didn't use to'.

At a glance

	Structure	Example
used to (affirmative)	subject + used to + base verb	I used to play tennis.
used to (negative)	subject + didn't use to + base verb	I didn't use to like it.
used to (question)	Did + subject + use to + base verb?	Did you use to live here?
would	subject + would + base verb	We would visit every summer.

Learning objectives

- Can use 'used to' for past habits and states, and 'would' for repeated past actions (CEFR B1).
- Can form the negative and question with 'use to' (no -d).
- Can distinguish 'used to + base' from 'be used to + -ing'.

Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Used to / Would (past habits) · CEFR B1

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. I ____ smoke, but I quit years ago.

A. used to

B. use to

C. am used to

D. would have

2. There ____ a castle on that hill.

A. would be

B. used to be

C. uses to be

D. would have

3. I ____ like vegetables when I was young.

A. didn't used to

B. didn't use to

C. don't used to

D. wasn't used to

4. Every winter, we ____ go skiing in the Pyrenees.

A. would

B. are used to

C. use to

D. would have

5. ____ you ____ live in Madrid?

A. Did / use to

B. Did / used to

C. Do / use to

D. Are / used to

6. I ____ getting up early now — it feels normal.

A. used to

B. am used to

C. would

D. use to

7. Correct this: 'My grandmother would have a big garden.'

A. My grandmother used to have a big garden.

B. My grandmother would has a big garden.

C. My grandmother use to have a big garden.

D. My grandmother is used to have a big garden.

8. We ____ play in the street as kids.

A. used to

B. are used to

C. use to

D. would have

9. Rewrite with the same meaning: 'In the past I played the piano, but not anymore.'

A. I used to play the piano.

B. I would have played the piano.

C. I am used to playing the piano.

D. I use to play the piano.

10. He ____ cycle to work, but now he drives.

A. used to

B. is used to

C. use to

D. would have

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **A. used to** — A finished past habit takes 'used to': 'I used to smoke'.
2. **B. used to be** — For a past state, use 'used to': 'There used to be a castle'.
3. **B. didn't use to** — The negative is 'didn't use to like'.
4. **A. would** — A repeated past action (a story) can take 'would': 'we would go skiing'.
5. **A. Did / use to** — Questions use 'Did + subject + use to': 'Did you use to live...?'.
6. **B. am used to** — 'Be used to + -ing' means accustomed: 'I am used to getting up early'.
7. **A. My grandmother used to have a big garden.** — 'Have a garden' is a past state, so use 'used to have'.
8. **A. used to** — A repeated past habit takes 'used to' (or 'would'): 'We used to play'.
9. **A. I used to play the piano.** — A finished past habit takes 'used to': 'I used to play the piano'.
10. **A. used to** — A finished past habit takes 'used to': 'He used to cycle to work'.